



Reflective Portfolio Assignment I Instructions

Introductory Psychology

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1 Pre-assignment Reminders

- Prior to attempting this assignment, I strongly recommend that you have completed all other work through module 4, including:
 - Having watched all lectures thoroughly and taken notes (optionally with the guided notes)
 - Reading all assigned sections of the book, and completing practice examples as helpful and useful
 - Completing relevant lecture check-ins
 - Completing all quizzes, and reviewing correct answers at the end of the week
- If you are confused while completing this assignment, consider coming to my office hours or reaching out to me via email.
- All syllabus and university policies on academic integrity, plagiarism, and other forms of misconduct apply to this assignment. Please review them if you are unfamiliar. There is zero-tolerance for failure to adhere to these policies and acting un-ethically will result in automatic failure on the assignment and referral to OSCCR.

! Important

Remember, it is most important to me that you can defend the process by which you create your work and demonstrate that it represents your knowledge and abilities. Also recall that it is unacceptable to copy-paste instructions from any assignment in this class into another program or prompt.

2 Prompt

This is the first of three reflective portfolio assignments that you will complete throughout the PSY-101 semester. These are designed to help bring this PSY-101 class in line with the 'Embarking Experience' as part of CLAS Voyage at GVSU. Please see the course learning objectives in the course syllabus and [this website for more information](#). Please keep track of what you say and write as part of these reflective portfolio assignments, as I'll ask you to connect your three different portfolio assignments. For this first assignment, I'd like you to respond to this prompt:

One goal of PSY-101 is to provide students with a more accurate, evidence-based understanding of human behavior. In a mini-essay of **at least 500 words**:

- Describe **two** things you learned in PSY-101 about human behavior or cognition, so far, that contradicted/challenged your earlier beliefs or surprised you. Make sure you describe how what we learned conflicts with your previously held beliefs. Be creative!
- For **each of these two things you've learned**, you should make *explicit* reference to where within the lectures this information appeared, as page number in the guided

notes or the slide number in the provided lecture slides (top right corner of presentations). For example: “I found this information on page 2 of the module 3 lecture guided notes” or “I found this information on slide number 10 of the module 2 lecture presentation”

- Also, discuss **two** strategies you can use in the future to evaluate the accuracy of claims about human behavior (hint: consider information the first two modules where we talked about the basis of empiricism and research methods).
- For **each of these two strategies**, you should make *explicit* reference to where within the lectures this information appeared, as page number in the guided notes or the slide number in the provided lecture slides (top right corner of presentations). E.g., “I found this information on page 2 of the module 3 lecture guided notes” or “I found this information on slide number 10 of the module 2 lecture presentation”

3 Checklist

! Important

Your grade on this assignment is based in good-faith completion - you must address each of the components below to get full points. Failure to properly source your information and answers (per the 2nd and 4th checkboxes) will result in an automatic 0 points. For the purpose of this assignment, please do not refer to outside sources not covered in this course.

- ☐ The final essay is at least 500 words
- ☐ Identified two things that challenged/conflicted with your prior beliefs or surprised you
- ☐ For each of the above two things, gave an explicit citation to the lectures with slide and/or page numbers from the lecture presentations and/or notes, respectively
- ☐ Identified two strategies for evaluating accuracy of claims about human behaviors
- ☐ For each of the above two strategies, gave an explicit citation to the lectures with slide and/or page numbers from the lecture presentations and/or notes, respectively

4 Instructor Example

! Important

You should NOT re-use this example/strategy for your own essay

The below example contains 1 example of a thing that challenged me, 1 citation for that challenge, 1 strategy for evaluating claims, and 1 citation for the claim. It is roughly 211 words. So, the example below is roughly half of what you must complete for your own submission. Please use this to help guide you on what I am expecting for this assignment.

“Previously, I had been under the impression that psychology couldn’t be considered a science, like chemistry, biology, or physics. I thought it was more floaty and theoretical, but not actually explored in a systemic way - I think this is mostly because I thought it wasn’t that different than philosophy. However, during Module 1, on slide number 9/41 and guided notes page number 4, I was immediately contradicted and informed that psychology **was** indeed a science. Prof. Quagliano explained a lot about how the empiricism in psychology comes from exploration of theories by making concrete, predictions, or hypotheses that help us determine whether we have evidence for certain trends. He also directly addressed my misconception that psychology was just philosophy, when he said that psychology *did* come from psychology, but developed into its own field (slide number 12/41, guided notes page 5). This came back during our Module 2 on psychological research, when we talked about how research usually follows the process of deductive reasoning (guided notes page 5, slide 12/39). I realized that acting deductively (like by making my own testable hypotheses) is a good way for me to better assess claims about human behavior that I hear, rather than just trusting the authority or expertise of others.”